Taewook Kim

Last update: October 24, 2026

Position **Postdoctoral Scholar**, Data Science Institute, The University of Chicago, Chicago, IL
Mentor: Ari Holtzman

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Research Interests

I build and study AI systems that can accelerate creative and scientific workflows while preserving human agency.
Keywords: Human-AI Interaction, Creativity Support, AI for Science, Interpretability, Evaluation, Human Agency

Education

2021–2026 **Ph.D.**, Technology and Social Behavior, Northwestern University, Evanston, IL
Joint Ph.D. in Computer Science and Communication Studies

Advisor: Matthew Kay, Committee Members: Darren Gergle, Duri Long, and Eytan Adar
Dissertation: Scaffolding User Control by Surfacing Latent Touchpoints in Human-AI Interaction

2018–2020 **M.Phil.**, Computer Science and Engineering, HKUST, Hong Kong SAR

Advisor: Xiaojuan Ma, Committee Members: Pan Hui and Dongwon Lee

2012–2018 **B.S.**, Business Administration, Hanyang University, Seoul, South Korea
B.S., Computer Science and Engineering (Dual Degrees)

Research Experience

Summer 2025 **Research Intern**, Toyota Research Institute, Los Altos, CA
Mentors: Matthew Hong and Matt Klenk

Summer 2024 **Visiting Researcher**, Accenture Labs, San Francisco, CA
Mentors: Manaswi Saha and Jordan Ackerman

Spring–Summer 2024 **Visiting Researcher**, Midjourney, Inc., San Francisco, CA
Mentors: John Joon Young Chung and Max Kreminski

Winter–Summer 2021 **Researcher**, KAIST Interaction Lab (KIXLAB), Daejeon, South Korea
Mentor: Juho Kim

Awards & Fellowships

2025 **Best Paper Honorable Mention**, ACM CSCW 2025, [P.8]
2025 **Nominated for the Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award**, Northwestern University
2024–2025 **Communication Graduate Fellowship** (Full tuition and stipend), Northwestern University
2024 **Best Paper Honorable Mention**, ACM CHI 2024, [P.7]
2023–2024 **Advanced Cognitive Science Fellowship** (Full tuition and stipend), Northwestern University
2022–2023 **HCI + Design Cluster Fellowship** (1/4 tuition and stipend), Northwestern University
2021–2022 **Computer Science Graduate Fellowship** (Full tuition and stipend), Northwestern University

Full Academic Publications

ACM CHI, ACM CSCW, and EMNLP are premier venues in Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) and Artificial Intelligence (AI), featuring full-paper peer review and typical acceptance rates of approximately 25%. They are regarded as on par with or above leading journals in these fields. (Total Citations: 295 — as of October 24, 2026)

P.12 **Persona-Driven Product Design Space Exploration with Multimodal LLMs**
Taewook Kim, Matthew Kay, and Members of Toyota Research Institute
arXiv preprint – Under review

P.11 **Scaffolding Creative Idea Exploration through Divergence and Convergence**
Taewook Kim, Matthew Kay, and Members of Midjourney
arXiv preprint

P.10 **Steering AI-driven Personalization of Scientific Text for General Audiences**
Taewook Kim, Dhruv Agarwal, Jordan Ackerman, Manaswi Saha
ACM CSCW 2025, PACM on Human-Computer Interaction 9 (7), 1-28, DOI: 10.1145/3757660

P.9 **LLMs Behind the Scenes: Enabling Narrative Scene Illustration**
Melissa Roemmele, John Joon Young Chung, Taewook Kim, Yuqian Sun, Alex Calderwood, Max Kreminski
EMNLP 2025

P.8 **MentalImager: Exploring Generative Images for Assisting Support-Seekers' Self-Disclosure in Online Mental Health Communities**
Han Zhang, Jiaqi Zhang, Yuxiang Zhou, Ryan Louie, Taewook Kim, Qingyu Guo, Shuailin Li, Zhenhui Peng
ACM CSCW 2025, PACM on Human-Computer Interaction 9 (2), 1-35, DOI: 10.1145/3711031
Best Paper Honorable Mention (top 5%)

P.7 **Authors' Values and Attitudes Towards AI-bridged Scalable Personalization of Creative Language Arts**
Taewook Kim, Hyomin Han, Eytan Adar, Matthew Kay, John Joon Young Chung
ACM CHI 2024 (Acceptance rate: 26.3%)
Best Paper Honorable Mention (top 5% among 4,028 submissions)

P.6 **Opportunities in Mental Health Support for Informal Dementia Caregivers Suffering from Verbal Agitation**
Taewook Kim, Hyeok Kim, Angela C. Roberts, Maia Jacobs, Matthew Kay
ACM CSCW 2024, PACM on Human-Computer Interaction 8 (CSCW1), 1-26, DOI: 10.1145/3637381

P.5 **RLens: A Computer-aided Visualization System for Supporting Reflection on Language Learning under Distributed Tutorship**
Meng Xia, Yankun Zhao, Jihyeong Hong, Mehmet Hamza Erol, Taewook Kim, Juho Kim
ACM L@S 2022

P.4 **Love in Lyrics: An Exploration of Supporting Textual Manifestation of Affection in Social Messaging**
Taewook Kim, Jung Soo Lee, Zhenhui Peng, and Xiaojuan Ma
ACM CSCW 2019, PACM on Human-Computer Interaction 3 (CSCW), 1-27, DOI: 10.1145/3359181

P.3 **Understanding and Modeling User-Perceived Brand Personality from Mobile Application UIs**
Ziming Wu, Taewook Kim, Quan Li, and Xiaojuan Ma
ACM CHI 2019 (Acceptance rate: 23.8%)

P.2 **Multidimensional Analysis of Consumers' Opinions from Online Product Reviews**
Taewook Kim, Dong Sung Kim, Donghyun Kim, Jong Woo Kim
Asia Pacific Journal of Information Systems 29 (4), 838-855, DOI: 10.14329/apjis.2019.29.4.838

P.1 **Mediating Color Filter Exploration with Color Theme Semantics Derived from Social Curation Data**
Ziming Wu, Zhida Sun, Taewook Kim, Manuele Reani, Caroline Jay, and Xiaojuan Ma
ACM CSCW 2018, PACM on Human-Computer Interaction 2 (CSCW), 1-24, DOI: 10.1145/3274456

Other Publications

Extended Abstracts, Posters, Workshops, and a Magazine Article

E.7 **Transforming Language to Improve Human Communication**
Taewook Kim, Duri Long
ACM CSCW 2024 Workshop on Envisioning New Futures of Positive Social Technology

E.6 **Rawal: A Reflection Assistant with Active Listening for Peer Support Chats**
Ryan Louie, Taewook Kim, Zhenhui Peng
ACM CHI 2023 Workshop on Self-Reflection Technologies

E.5 **Opportunities to Support Communal Experiences of Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing People in Live Popular Music Concerts**
Hyomin Han, Taewook Kim
ACM GROUP 2022 Poster

E.4 **Facilitating Continuous Text Messaging in Romantic Encounters Online by Expanded Keywords Enumeration**
Taewook Kim, Qingyu Guo, Hyeonjae Kim, Wenjie Yang, Meiziniu Li, Xiaojuan Ma
ACM CSCW 2022 Poster

E.3 **Improving Readers' Awareness of Divergent Viewpoints by Displaying Agendas of Comments in Online News Discussions**
Taewook Kim, Hyunwoo Kim, Juho Kim, and Xiaojuan Ma
ACM CSCW 2021 Poster

E.2 **GremoBot: Exploring Emotion Regulation in Group Chat**
Zhenhui Peng, Taewook Kim, and Xiaojuan Ma
ACM CSCW 2019 Poster

E.1 **Literature and AI - Expecting Roles of Bridging Writers and Readers**
John Joon Young Chung, Taewook Kim
The Poet's Notebook (A Quarterly Magazine): Summer, 2023

Patent

Taewook Kim and Members of Toyota Research Institute. Personalized Image Generation Based on Virtual Customer Profiles. U.S. Patent Application, filed March 2026 (pending).

Selected Invited Talks

2026 **MBZUAI** (hosted by Prof. Elizabeth Churchill).
2025 **Toyota Research Institute** (hosted by Dr. Laura Libby).
2025 **Toyota Research Institute** (hosted by Dr. Matthew Hong).
2024 **Accenture Labs** (hosted by Dr. Manaswi Saha).

Teaching Experience

Winter 2025 **Teaching Assistant**, Technology and Human Interaction, Northwestern University
Fall 2019 **Teaching Assistant**, Human-Computer Interaction, HKUST
Spring 2019 **Teaching Assistant**, Design and Analysis of Algorithms, HKUST

Academic Services

- **Associate Chair (AC)**

2025 ACM CHI

- **Reviewer** (★) *Special Recognitions for Outstanding Reviews*

2019–Present ACM CHI, ★ (2022), ★ (2023), ★ (2024), ★★ (2025)
2021–Present ACM CSCW, ★ (2022), ★ (2023)
2024–Present ACM UIST, ★ (2024), ★ (2025)
2025–Present ACM DIS
2024 ACM IUI
2023–2024 ACL In2Writing Workshop

- **Student Volunteer**

2022 ACM CHI

Referees

Name Matthew Kay
PhD Advisor
Contact mjskay@northwestern.edu
Position Associate Professor
Affiliation Department of Computer Science
Northwestern University

Name Darren Gergle
Thesis Committee
Contact dgergle@northwestern.edu
Position Bao Family Professor
Affiliation Department of Computer Science
Northwestern University

Name Eytan Adar
Thesis Committee
Contact eadar@umich.edu
Position Professor
Affiliation School of Information
University of Michigan

Name Duri Long
Thesis Committee
Contact duri@northwestern.edu
Position Assistant Professor
Affiliation School of Communication
Northwestern University

Name Max Kreminski
Mentor at Midjourney
Contact mk2758@cornell.edu
Position Assistant Professor
Affiliation Design Tech
Cornell Tech

Name Matthew Hong
Mentor at Toyota Research Institute
Contact matt.hong@tri.global
Position Senior Research Scientist
Affiliation Human-Centered AI Division
Toyota Research Institute